Social Media Marketing

The dark side of social media

Summary Notes

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Lesson outcomes

- Developing a social media policy
- How to handle a social media crisis
- Social media listening
- Avoidable social media fails
- Types of social media users

Fun Fact

DID YOU KNOW: On average companies can expect to lose about $4.3 million in global sales from social media mistakes. searchenginejournal.com

Social media policy

What is a social media policy?

A social media policy is a living document that outlines a corporate code of conduct that provides guidelines for employees who post content on the internet.

Benefits of a social media policy

- Can help to maintain brand identity consistently across multiple social media channels
- Takes consideration of legal and regulatory sensitivities
- Can help to prevent security breaches
- Assists in preventing a PR crisis
- Allows for quick emergency response times
- Makes employees aware of their social media responsibilities and encourages brand advocacy

Your social media policy should include;

- Roles and responsibilities
- Security protocols
- Crisis management
- Law compliance
- Personal and social media accounts
- Employee participation

View examples of social media policies

Adidas, Mayo Clinic, Reuters, General Motors

Implementing your social media policy

1. Draft your policy
1. Get stakeholder input
2. Ensure it is in an accessible location
3. Launch or relaunch policy
4. Review annually

Social media crisis management

What is crisis management?

Crisis management is the strategy that an organisation implements to deal with negative events which threaten to harm the reputation of an organisation.

Pre-crisis

Create a team dedicated to responding to a crisis

- Executive personnel to enforce decisions
- Management to coordinate recovery efforts
- Creatives to craft the right message
- Possibly a lawyer

When you have identified your team, ask yourself;

- Who will take ownership for the overall crisis response strategy?
- Who is responsible for identifying and monitoring a potential crisis?
- Who is going to inform management and stakeholders?
- Who will manage social media responses?
- Who will handle messages from other channels?
- Who will act as the media spokesperson?

Define your crisis levels

- Information asymmetry: when you don't know any more than the public
- Change from norm: excludes every day criticism
- Serious risk to company: when the event has a truly negative effect on company

Develop a crisis response flow chart

- Customer service staff can respond → No escalation required
- Customer service staff respond with management guidance → Escalated to manager
- Manager gets directly involved → May need further escalation
- Manager responds and executive team is notified → Create content and monitoring if necessary - Escalation required
- Executive team responds to develop multiple pieces of content → Heavy monitoring required

Compile a crisis communication plan

- Keep core values top of mind
- Main value proposition
- Align emergency responses with brand voice
- Prepare for as many situations as possible
- Engage but don't argue
- Internal communication processes to follow during a time of crisis
- Contact information for critical employees
- Pre-approved messages
- Approval process for messaging

During crisis

- Pause all scheduled posts
- Publicly acknowledge the event
- Inform your team
- Create a crisis FAQ page or post
- Keep the public updated
- Response rule of two
- Use visuals to inform

Crisis recovery

- Assess the damage
- Reflect on response plan - how effective was it?
- Is there any long-term damage?
- Does this issue require continuous coverage?
- Adjust your response plan accordingly
- Let the dust settle

Social listening

To effectively and quickly identify any potential crisis you need good social listening.

What is social listening?

Social media listening is the monitoring of a brand's social media in order to identify direct mentions and customer feedback around the brand, specific keywords, topics, competitors and a specific industry followed by analysis.

Social listening allows you to;

- Have a responsive and active online presence
- Track your brand growth
- Identify potential opportunities
- Increase customer acquisition

Steps to successful social listening:

1. Identify keywords, topics and competitors to monitor
2. Identify which platforms they talk on and what are they talking about
3. What is being said about your competitors
4. Monitor any changes taking place
5. Analyse what the data says
6. Take action according to the data

Social listening tools

- Hubspot
- Buffer
- Buzzsumo
- Sproutsocial
- SumAll
- Mention

12 Avoidable social media fails

1. Losing your cool
2. Being in constant sales mode
3. Inappropriate news jacking
4. Lack of research
5. Getting involved in politics
6. Not getting a 2nd or 3rd opinion
7. Social selling VS social marketing
8. The wrong influencer
9. Separating real life from social media
10. Not keeping up-to-date with current trends
11. Not training employees
12. No social media presence

Types of social media users

The listener

- Fly under the radar
- Rarely engage
- Hard to please
- High-quality content that is immensely creative might prompt an engagement

The activist

- Drive change
- Love technology
- Fiercely opinionated
- Witty, creative, energetic and socially/environmentally conscious content

The spammer

- Low quality content
- Share promotional messages
- Like, share and comment on everything!

The passionista

- Explore and share passions
- Super excited to motivate others
- Popular and conscientious
- Get behind social causes

The social butterfly

- Always tagged in every picture
- Borderline spammer
- Engage with sponsored ads, chatting on groups, liking pages, tweeting, intsagramming, etc.
- Easily accessible
- Immense outreach

The troll

- Crosses the line from unpleasant opposition to hate speech
- Hyper-critical
- Negative
- Rarely constructive or complimentary

The influencer

- High-quality content
- Passionate and knowledgeable about their topic
- Adopt the use of influencers
- Make sure you are using the right person

The early adopter

- Adopt multiple social media channels
- They will engage if the content is high-quality
- Stay on top of trends

The black booker

- Relationship builder
- They give, share and contribute
- These are useful followers to engage with

The family person

- Use social media to connect with family
- Posting about family
- More willing to buy a product or service on the recommendation of a family member
- Engage them with through interactive content